Arabs. The Arab commander and his army fled to Tashkent after they were defeated.[†] [‡]

The Tibetan empire regained the Tarim Basin in the third decade of the eighth century. But the Tang dynasty again annexed the region just two decades later. In AD 751, the Battle of Talas took place between the Abbasids backed by the Tibetan Empire and the Tang Dynasty. This led to the gradual withdrawal of Chinese forces completely. Later, it became a land of contest only between the Uyghurs and the Tibetans.

Aksu was always a critical destination for all powers given its strategic position. It existed on the junction of the Northern-Tarim route Silk Road, and the dangerous route north via the Tian Shan's Muzart Pass to the fertile Ili River valley.[§]

Then came the era of one of the most dominating forces of that period. Between AD 1207–08, they had submitted to Genghis Khān. By AD 1220, Aksu had become the capital of the Kingdom of Mangalai. The region served as a part of the great Mongol Empire but in AD 1286, it slipped out of Kublai's Yuan Dyasty and went to Chagatai Khānate under the House of Ogedei. Yuan Dynasty and Chagatai Khānate had completely declined by the mid- and the end of the fourteenth century, respectively, following which Turkic powers and Mongol warlords took complete control.

Babur's Narrative Resumes

As Sulṭān Ahmad Mīrzā died, his loyal, demotivated begs agreed to invite Sulṭān Mahmud Mīrzā with the intent to offer him succession. They sent a courier by the mountain road to him. On the other hand, Babur's grandfather, Abu Sa'id Mīrzā's eldest brother, Manuchihr Mīrzā's son Malik Muhammad was aspiring to become the ruler. The desperate begs, who were focused on their goals, had drifted away from Sulṭān Ahmad Mīrzā's camp aligning with Samarkand. Few say that Ahmad Mīrzā's control had weakened. He was failing to affect anything. His miscalculated and ineffective steps not only cost him his life but many other loyal patrons of the house.

Without wasting much time, Sulṭān Mahmud Mīrzā accepted the begs' invitation and went off to Samarkand, seating himself on the throne with ease. This made the begs happy. However, many soldiers, lower staff and peasants were disgusted. As one of his first moves, Sulṭān Mahmud Mīrzā exiled his cousin and son-in-law Malik Muhammad, and the three Mīrzās to Kuk-sarai to